MODULE 32 · ALL DOMAINS

What Changed Since the Guide

Every change from July to October 2026 that touches the exam, dated, with the exam-safe reading of each: models, the API, tools and MCP, Claude Code, and the new Usage Policy.

GUIDE v1.0, July 2026 CHECKED 21 Oct 2026 MODULE 32 of 36

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A map printed in July is still right about the mountains. It is the roads that move. Learn the mountains, then check the roads.

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The rule for currency questions

- **Answer with the engineering principle.** The version detail is a currency check.
- **Prefer the option that is true under old and new behaviour** when both seem to fit.
- **A newer feature is not automatically right.** It still has to fit the requirement.
- **Sampling, prefill and forced tool choice** appear as concepts, never as the fix.
- **In real projects, check the docs on the day.** This module is dated 21 Oct 2026.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> The guide tests decisions. Every change here leaves the ten rules standing.

Models since the guide

DATE	CHANGE	EXAM-SAFE READING
24 Jul	Opus 5; effort adds xhigh and max	Effort is a ladder; raise it first
1 Sep	Fable 5.1 and Mythos 5.1 above Opus	Top tier only when evals demand it
22 Sep	Opus 5.5 at USD 4 / 20; thinking always on	Thinking is on by default on 5.x
28 Sep	Sonnet 5.5; between_tools replaces disabled	Read each model's migration notes
7 Oct	Haiku 5.5; Sonnet 5.5 cache reads halved	Smallest tier that passes the evals

CURRENCY CHECK

Sonnet 4.5 was deprecated on 30 Sep and retires on 30 Nov 2026. Retired models fail every request.

API and platform since the guide

DATE	CHANGE	EXAM-SAFE READING
19 Aug	Files API, Skills and computer use GA	Use what the platform gives you
20 Aug	Python SDK 1.0 drops sampling parameters	Sampling is never the fix
14 Oct	OpenTelemetry trace export, beta	Evidence before change
15 Oct	Fast mode GA on Opus 5.5	Paid speed: about 2x the price
21 Oct	API version 2026-10-21; new SDK majors	Upgrade with fixes, tested first

CURRENCY CHECK

Also new: user profiles (20 Oct) tag each request with the end customer it serves.

API version 2026-10-21, in one request

BEFORE

Fine under 2023-06-01

```python
client.messages.create(
  model="claude-sonnet-4-5",
  temperature=0.2,
  max_tokens=1024,
  messages=msgs,
)
```

Sampling dial; a retiring model.

AFTER

Valid under 2026-10-21

```python
client.messages.create(
  model="claude-sonnet-5-5",
  output_config={"effort": "medium"},
  max_tokens=1024,
  messages=msgs,
)
```

No sampling; effort and evals instead.

ON THE EXAM

temperature, top_p and top_k return 400 on every model under the new version, even at their defaults.

API version 2026-10-21: the breaking changes

CHANGE	NOW	DO INSTEAD
temperature, top_p, top_k	400, even at defaults	Examples, schemas, effort
Document in an assistant turn	400	Send documents in user turns
Citations on user text blocks	400	Citations come from Claude's output
SDK majors (Python 2.0.0)	Send it by default	Test, release with fixes
Amazon Bedrock	Claude 4.7 and later only	Check each platform

CURRENCY CHECK

No sunset date for 2023-06-01 announced. Anthropic recommends the latest.

Agents, MCP and Claude Code

WHEN	CHANGE	EXAM-SAFE READING
28 Jul	MCP 2026-07-28: stateless; sampling, roots, logging deprecated	stdio and Streamable HTTP
Aug-Oct	Managed Agents: budgets, dynamic workflows (beta)	Hosted harness when it fits
Current	Custom commands merged into Skills; subagent tool is Agent	Same ideas, new names
Current	Auto mode is the interactive starting mode	Managed settings still decide
Current	AGENTS.md read natively; auto memory on	Context files still load

THE TRAP

The guide's "transports (stdio, sockets)": the standard pair is stdio and Streamable HTTP.

The Usage Policy from 12 November 2026

- **High-risk use cases:** human-in-the-loop and disclosure, unchanged; covered recommendations now listed.
- **Physical actions:** a qualified operator can observe and stop the equipment; a safe state on disconnect.
- **Deceptive campaigns** gather in one new section; surveillance rules rewritten.
- **Weapons** explicitly cover software and components that make them work.
- **Sustained, needless abuse of the model** is newly prohibited, in extreme cases only.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> High-risk rules are met by design, with review and disclosure built in, not by prompts.

Guide wording, read today

THE GUIDE SAYS	TODAY	ANSWER WITH
Extended thinking	Adaptive on current models; budget_tokens rejected	Thinking as a capability; effort
Sampling	Removed in API version 2026-10-21	A concept, never the fix
Transports (stdio, sockets)	stdio and Streamable HTTP	The standard pair
Websockets	Claude API streams over SSE	General engineering

THE TIEBREAKER

When the guide's wording and today's platform differ, the decision the question tests rarely does.

> A team upgrades its services to the new major version of the Python SDK. One service, which sets temperature=0.3 on every call, now fails every request with HTTP 400.
>
> The other services still work.

What should the team do?

A Pin that service to the old SDK major permanently

B Set the temperature to its default value instead

C Force the old API version header and keep the temperature

D Remove sampling parameters, run the evals, then release

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the team do?

A Pin that service to the old SDK major permanently

Postpones the same break.

B Set the temperature to its default value instead

Even the default returns 400.

C Force the old API version header and keep the temperature

Keeps a dial current models reject.

D Remove sampling parameters, run the evals, then release

Fixed, tested, released together.

THE SIGNAL

Upgrade with the fixes, tested. The new version rejects sampling parameters even at their defaults.

> A teammate follows a 2025 tutorial and sends Opus 5.5 a request with thinking set to enabled and budget_tokens of 8,000. It returns HTTP 400.
>
> She asks you why.

What should you tell her?

A. This model does not support thinking at all

B. Adaptive thinking now, steered by effort

C. The budget must be at least sixteen thousand tokens

D. Thinking needs a beta header on this model

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should you tell her?

A. This model does not support thinking at all
Thinking is always on for this model.

B. Adaptive thinking now, steered by effort
Budgets are the older interface.

C. The budget must be at least sixteen thousand tokens
No budget is accepted on current models.

D. Thinking needs a beta header on this model
No header is involved.

THE SIGNAL

A token budget is the older interface. On current models, thinking adapts and effort steers it.

> Thirty internal teams' agents will share one remote MCP server for HR lookups.
>
> A teammate's notes from early 2026 recommend the HTTP+SSE transport, with session state held on the server.

What should the team build?

A Streamable HTTP, stateless per the current spec

B HTTP+SSE with server-side sessions, as the notes say

C The stdio transport, run on each team's machine

D WebSocket, as the standard remote transport

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the team build?

A Streamable HTTP, stateless per the current spec
Current spec, remote and shared.

B HTTP+SSE with server-side sessions, as the notes say
Deprecated transport.

C The stdio transport, run on each team's machine
Local only; thirty copies.

D WebSocket, as the standard remote transport
Not a standard transport.

THE SIGNAL

Remote and shared means Streamable HTTP. The current spec is stateless, so do not lean on server sessions.

> A service pins claude-sonnet-4-5-20250929. Anthropic's deprecation notice gives a retirement date of 30 November 2026.
>
> The feature has an evaluation set of 300 cases.

What is the best plan?

A Wait until requests start failing, then switch

B Change the model ID to the new model in production today

C Switch to the undated alias so the service keeps working

D Evals on the new model, then a canary before the date

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the best plan?

A Wait until requests start failing, then switch

An outage by design.

B Change the model ID to the new model in production today

An untested model change.

C Switch to the undated alias so the service keeps working

Points at the same retiring model.

D Evals on the new model, then a canary before the date

Evidence, then a gradual rollout.

THE SIGNAL

A model change is a release: evals, migration notes, a canary, all before the retirement date.

> A live coding assistant runs on Opus 5.5. Users complain that long answers stream slowly once they start.
>
> Quality is right, and the product can afford a higher price per token.

What should the team try?

A Move the assistant's requests to the Batch API

B Switch to Haiku for every coding answer

C Turn on fast mode, now generally available

D Raise max_tokens so answers finish sooner

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the team try?

A Move the assistant's requests to the Batch API
Slower, not faster.

B Switch to Haiku for every coding answer
Risks the quality that is right.

C Turn on fast mode, now generally available
Faster output, same model.

D Raise max_tokens so answers finish sooner
Does not change speed.

THE SIGNAL

Fast mode speeds output tokens, not time to first token, and costs about twice as much.

> A lender builds a Claude feature that recommends whether to approve loan applications.
>
> The Usage Policy treats this as a high-risk use case.

Which two must the design include? Choose two.

- A — A qualified person reviews each recommendation
- B — A system prompt telling Claude to always be fair
- C — No mention of AI, so applicants are not biased
- D — Disclosure to applicants that AI was used
- E — Automatic approval below a set loan size

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two must the design include? Choose two.

A. A qualified person reviews each recommendation
Human in the loop.

B. A system prompt telling Claude to always be fair
Guidance, not a requirement met.

C. No mention of AI, so applicants are not biased
The opposite of disclosure.

D. Disclosure to applicants that AI was used
Disclosure to those affected.

E. Automatic approval below a set loan size
Removes the human from the loop.

THE SIGNAL

High-risk uses need a qualified human in the loop and disclosure that AI was used. Design, not prompts.

Module 32 in five lines

- **Principle first:** the version detail is a currency check, not the answer.
- **Models:** 5.5 family, thinking on by default, effort as the first lever.
- **API 2026-10-21:** no sampling parameters; upgrade SDKs with fixes, tested.
- **Agents and MCP:** stateless MCP, Skills absorb commands, auto mode by default.
- **Usage Policy, 12 Nov:** high-risk review and disclosure, met by design.

COMING UP

Next: how CCDV-F questions are written - the ten rules against the distractor families.